

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	29 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-2452
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement:



Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Brainstorming session record for the ServiceNow Transform Map project, completed using the Mural Brainstorm & Idea prioritization template.

10 minutes to prepare
1 hour to collaborate
4 people participated

Project details

Phase	Ideation Phase
Date	29 September 2026
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Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Team members

#	Team Member	Role	Responsibility
1	Rajapriyan. D	Team Lead	Overall coordination, final documentation
2	Sreedev. A	Data Preparation	Prepare and validate the spreadsheet (Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location)
3	Vignesh. A	ServiceNow Configuration	Create target table, Import Set and Transform Map
4	Mohammed Irfan Ali. A	Testing & Validation	Run transform, verify records, capture screenshots

● Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what was done to get going.

10 minutes

A Team gathering

The four team members (Team Lead, Data Preparation, ServiceNow Configuration, Testing & Validation) joined the session. Each prepared their own area: spreadsheet, Import Set / Transform Map setup, and validation.

B Set the goal

Focus the session on one problem: replace slow, error-prone manual entry of employee records with a repeatable import from a spreadsheet into a ServiceNow table using Import Sets and Transform Maps.

C Learn how to use the facilitation tools

The Mural Facilitation Superpowers (sticky notes, tags, laser pointer, voting) were used to keep the session happy and productive.

1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Framed as a How Might We statement, this is the focus of the brainstorm.

5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we import employee records from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow quickly, accurately and without duplicates, using Import Sets and Transform Maps?

Selected problem statement: Manually entering employee records from spreadsheets into ServiceNow is slow, error-prone and creates duplicate records. The team needs an automated, repeatable way to import spreadsheet data into a ServiceNow table.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping:

2 Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

10 minutes

TIP
You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil icon to start drawing!

Rajapriyan. D

Create a custom target table

Create a Transform Map from staging table to target table

Use Employee ID as the Coalesce field to avoid duplicates

Add a transform script for cleaning (trim spaces, lower-case email)

Sreedev. A

Use one clean spreadsheet template with fixed column headers

Remove blank rows and duplicate Employee IDs before upload

Keep a sample dataset of 10 rows for quick testing

Vignesh. A

Load file with System Import Sets > Load Data

Create the Import Set (staging) table from the file headers

Inspect staged rows before transforming

Mohammed Irfan Ali. A

Run the transform and read the Transform History

Compare row counts: file vs staging vs target

Schedule automated imports in future using a Data Source

3 Group ideas

Similar ideas were clustered and each cluster was given a sentence-like label.

20 minutes

TIP
Tags can be added to sticky notes to find, browse and categorize ideas as themes.

Prepare clean, consistent spreadsheet data

Fixed template

Remove blanks / duplicates

Sample dataset (10 rows)

Load the file into an Import Set staging table

Load Data module

Staging table from headers

Inspect staged rows

Design the Transform Map to avoid duplicates

Target table sample_employee

Field mapping

Coalesce on Employee ID

Transform script (cleanup)

Validate results and automate later

Transform History

Row-count comparison

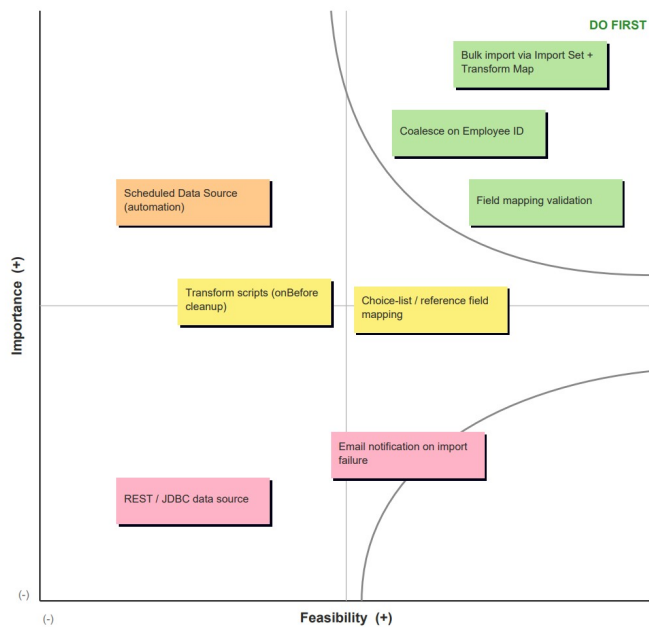
Scheduled import (Data Source)

Step-3: Idea Prioritization:

4 Prioritize

Ideas are placed on the grid by Importance (vertical) and Feasibility (horizontal). The top-right is implemented first.

20 minutes



Priority ranking

Rank	Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Decision
1	Bulk import via Import Set + Transform Map	High	High	Implement (core)
2	Coalesce on Employee ID	High	High	Implement (core)
3	Field mapping validation	High	High	Implement (core)
4	Choice-list / reference field mapping	Medium	Medium	If time permits
5	Transform scripts (onBefore cleanup)	Medium	Medium	Optional
6	Scheduled Data Source (automation)	Medium	Low	Future scope
7	Email notification on import failure	Low	Medium	Future scope

After you collaborate

Outcome of the session and what was decided for the project.

Session outcome

Core scope (implement first): bulk import via Import Set + Transform Map, Coalesce on Employee ID to prevent duplicate records, and field mapping validation.

If time permits: choice-list / reference field mapping. Optional: onBefore transform script to trim spaces and lower-case email addresses.

Future scope: scheduled imports with a Data Source, and email notification on import failure. REST/JDBC data source was rated low priority.

Next steps

#	Action	Owner	Status
1	Prepare and validate spreadsheet (Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location)	Sreedev. A	Next
2	Create sample_employee table, Import Set and Transform Map with Coalesce on Employee ID	Vignesh. A	Next
3	Run transform, check Transform History, compare row counts, capture screenshots	Mohammed Irfan Ali. A	Next
4	Consolidate results and prepare final documentation	Rajapriyan. D	Next